

SERVING PLAN 4 SERVING PLAN

# Chicken and Wild Rice Soup

## with Leeks, Carrots, and Spinach

Wild rice isn't technically rice, but a long-grain marsh grass that's about the same shape and size. It has a nutty flavor, chewy texture, and dark color that makes other ingredients pop. Here, we stir it into a creamy broth that's packed with bites of shredded chicken. Plenty of leeks, carrots, and spinach ensure you'll get your veggie fix.

35–45 minutes  660 calories per serving

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## Ingredients

- 1 cup wild rice
- 4 boneless skinless chicken breasts
- 2 leeks
- 4 ounces baby spinach
- 8 ounces carrots
- 2 celery stalks
- 3 cloves garlic
- ¼ cup flour
- 5 packets unsalted butter
- 24 ounces milk
- 2 chicken bouillon cubes

## You'll need

olive oil
kosher salt
black pepper
8" medium pot with lid
10" large pot

## Recipe tips

Be sure to read through the entire recipe before you begin cooking.

The amount of water isn't indicated because you'll drain the rice, just like pasta, when it's finished cooking.

Cooking with a helper? They can **separate the leeks** in Step 3 and **pat them dry** in Step 4, then **shred the chicken** in Step 5.

Flour helps thicken the soup as it simmers. Stir it into the aromatics before adding the liquid to toast it slightly and prevent any flour lumps in your soup.

The chicken might have a slight odor as a natural reaction to its vacuum packing. USDA recommends cooking chicken to 165°F.

Questions? Email help@plated.com or call 855-525-2399. Visit plated.me/allergens for more information on dietary restrictions.

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### 1. Cook wild rice

Bring a medium, covered pot of water to a boil over high heat (covering the pot helps the water boil faster). Season boiling water generously with **salt**. Stir in **wild rice** and cook until almost tender, 25–28 minutes (see recipe tip). Drain **wild rice** and return to pot, off heat. Cover to keep warm until Step 6.



### 2. Cook chicken

While wild rice cooks, pat **chicken** dry with paper towel and season all over with **1 teaspoon salt** and **pepper**. Heat **1 tablespoon olive oil** in a large pot over medium-high heat. When oil is shimmering, add **chicken** and sear, working in batches and adding oil in between as needed, until cooked through and no longer pink, 5–7 minutes per side. Transfer **chicken** to a plate and set aside to rest. Reserve pot, off heat, for Step 4.



### 3. Prepare ingredients

While chicken cooks, if **leeks** arrived with dark green tops, trim and discard them. Halve **leeks** lengthwise, then cut crosswise into ¼-inch half-moons. Place in a bowl of cold water, separating pieces, to let dirt sink to bottom (see recipe tip). Rinse remaining produce. Pat **spinach** dry with paper towel. Halve **carrots** and **celery stalks** lengthwise, then thinly slice crosswise on a diagonal. Mince **garlic**.



### 4. Sauté aromatics

Use a slotted spoon or your hands to remove **leeks** from water, then pat dry with paper towel. Return pot from chicken to medium-high heat with **1 tablespoon olive oil**. When oil is shimmering, add **leeks**, **carrots**, **celery**, **garlic**, **¼ teaspoon salt**, and **pepper** as desired. Sauté, stirring occasionally, until beginning to soften, 3–4 minutes.



### 5. Simmer soup and shred chicken

To pot with aromatics, still over medium-high heat, add **flour**, **butter** and **¼ teaspoon salt** (see recipe tip). Cook, stirring continuously, until flour is lightly browned, 1–2 minutes. Whisk in **milk**, **bouillon cubes**, and **4 cups water**. Bring to a boil over high heat, then reduce heat to medium high. Simmer, stirring occasionally, until cubes are dissolved and soup is slightly thickened, 6–7 minutes more. Meanwhile, shred rested **chicken** using 2 forks or roughly chop.



### 6. Plate chicken soup

To pot with soup, still over medium-high heat, stir in **shredded chicken** and cooked **wild rice**. Cook, stirring, until flavors have melded, 2–3 minutes. Season with **¾ teaspoon salt** and **pepper**; remove pot from heat. Stir in **spinach** to wilt. Let **chicken and wild rice soup** cool slightly, about 5 minutes, then ladle into serving bowls. Garnish with **pepper**. Dig in!

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